

Permanent Residence

According to Table 5.1.8, 97.9 percent (454,034) of the total population in Sri Lanka reside in the same district as their permanent residence. Among the usually resident population, the highest percentage of those holding permanent residence in a different district is reported in the Colombo District (5.5%). This figure stands at 3.9 percent in the Gampaha District, while Kilinochchi and Vavuniya districts reported 3.4 percent and 2.1 percent respectively. In all other districts, this percentage remains below 2 percent.

Table 5.1.8 : Distribution of the Usually Resident Population of a District by their Permanent Residence, 2024

Usual residence District	usual residence Population* (a)	Population usually reside in permanent residence district		Population with permanent residence in another district	
		Number (b)	Percentage	Number (a-b)	Percentage
Total	21,779,483	21,325,449	97.9	454,034	2.1
Colombo	2,374,869	2,244,323	94.5	130,546	5.5
Gampaha	2,435,913	2,340,241	96.1	95,672	3.9
Kalutara	1,305,708	1,287,854	98.6	17,854	1.4
Kandy	1,461,755	1,434,821	98.1	26,934	1.8
Matale	526,849	518,870	98.5	7,979	1.5
Nuwara Eliya	725,251	719,906	99.3	5,345	0.7
Galle	1,097,225	1,084,085	98.8	13,140	1.2
Matara	837,756	825,062	98.5	12,694	1.5
Hambantota	671,383	664,855	99.0	6,528	1.0
Jaffna	594,699	585,641	98.5	9,058	1.5
Mannar	123,752	122,800	99.2	952	0.8
Vavuniya	172,280	168,602	97.8	3,678	2.1
Mullaitivu	122,617	120,696	98.4	1,921	1.6
Kilinochchi	136,710	132,107	96.6	4,603	3.4
Batticaloa	595,889	588,704	98.8	7,185	1.2
Ampara	744,531	735,399	98.8	9,132	1.2
Trincomalee	442,722	438,683	99.1	4,039	0.9
Kurunegala	1,768,023	1,742,683	98.6	25,340	1.4
Puttalam	818,703	805,775	98.4	12,928	1.6
Anuradhapura	959,901	944,348	98.4	15,553	1.6
Polonnaruwa	447,503	441,668	98.7	5,835	1.3
Badulla	872,239	861,106	98.7	11,133	1.3
Moneragala	527,532	522,063	99.0	5,469	1.0
Ratnapura	1,145,252	1,134,639	99.1	10,613	0.9
Kegalle	870,421	860,518	98.9	9,903	1.1

*Excluding roofless population and person whose permanent residence is another country.